chunks/parcels as such. The agriculture use land is surveyed in detail and land records provide owner-wise details for all operational holdings. The abadi land is also classified in one chunky plot with no individual details about each house plot.

In short, the entire land classification and management system exists for management of land as agricultural. There are excessively stringent rules for transfer of land for non-agricultural use. Owing to the policy framework in the past seventy-five years, land availability is scarce for residential, industrial, infrastructure and other non-agricultural use. This has led to the price of land for these uses to become extraordinarily high, making many residential, industrial, infrastructure and other projects unviable and non-competitive. India's road construction programme has become a government-funded programme because of excessively high land costs that give private enterprise no chance to make profits.

Despite certain negative consequences, harnessing India's water by constructing dams and barrages was absolutely necessary to prevent flooding of plains and runoff of precious rainwater to the seas. That investment was necessary. India has still not been able to stop all water run-off, most notably in the North-east.

However, water dammed with massive investments and cost to people has been primarily reserved for use in agriculture. The government made unusually liberal water allowances for irrigation in the leaking lands of Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan and Gujarat from the dams built in the Himalayas and Vindhyas. The water allowance in Stage 1 Phase 1 of the Indira Gandhi Canal in the districts of Ganganagar, Hanumangarh and Bikaner in Rajasthan was 5.23 cusecs per chak of 404.7 hectares. This was many times over the efficient requirement. It was reduced in the second stage to 3.05 cusecs per chak. In Phase 2, the water allowance has been less than 2 cusecs per chak. The vested interests created in receiving about three times the water required in Stage 1 of Phase 1 have not allowed the water